CLASS 9 • SST • EXAM WORKBOOK

CIVICS

the Workbook

Poora exam prep — samajhne wali **Hinglish notes**, likhne wale **English points**, saare **definitions**, **system trees** (iske under kya, uske under kya), **differences** aur full **practice set** (MCQs + big Q&A). All from your textbook, nothing missed.

6 **Democracy**
Democratic traditions, principles (popular sovereignty, rule of law, rights, separation of powers), types of democracy, India's living democracy & challenges

7 **Elections**
Why elections matter, FPTP & PR systems, election laws, ECI & its machinery, political parties, anti-defection law & challenges

💡 Hinglish Samajh · ✍️ Exam-Ready Points · 📖 Definition Bank · 🌳 System Trees · ⚖️ Differences · ✅ 10 + 10 MCQs · 📝 10 + 10 Big Q&A · 🎯 Under 20 Pages

Let's go! 🚀

1 · SAMAJH
Pehle 💡 Hinglish box padh — topic ka feel aa jayega

2 · RATTAAA
📖 Definition + ✍️ points yaad kar — yehi likhne ke hain

3 · TEST
MCQs khud solve kar, phir answers check kar 💪

4 · WRITE
Big Q&A dekh — points ko apne answers me copy-paryog karo

CHAPTER 6 • CIVICS

Democracy

Democracy = power **logon ke haath** me. Is chapter me: India ke democratic traditions (Vedic times se), democracy ke saare principles, types of democracy, India ki living democracy ka scale, aur challenges — sab kuch, step by step.



🔑 11 Topics | 📖 25+ Definitions | 🌳 6 System Trees | ✅ 10 MCQs | 📝 10 Q&A

📚 Notes — Har Topic, Poori Samajh

T1 Democracy — Meaning + India 🇮🇳

☐ revised

📖 DEFINITION

Democracy — a form of government in which the **source of power and authority lies with the citizens** of the country, who elect their representatives through **free and fair elections**. It is founded on the principles of **freedom, equality, justice, rights and duties**.

💡 SAMAJH (HINGLISH)

Simple seedha: **janta boss**, neta employee! Log apne representatives **vote** se chunte hain, wahi policies banate hain. India is the **world's largest democracy** — 140+ crore ki population, aur **96.8 crore voters (2024)** — itna bada election kahin nahi hota! Backbone hai hamari **Constitution**: adopted **26 November 1949**, in force **26 January 1950** (isliye Republic Day!).

✍️ EXAM POINTS

- Citizens have the right to **vote, express opinions, and participate in decision-making**.
- The Constitution **guarantees and protects Fundamental Rights** of all citizens.
- No citizen is discriminated against on the basis of **religion, race, caste, sex, or place of birth**.
- It encourages citizen participation at the **national, state, and local levels** through elections.
- Constitution of India: adopted **26 November 1949**, came into force **26 January 1950**.

T2 Tracing Democratic Traditions — Ancient se Aaj Tak 🕰️

☐ revised

💡 SAMAJH (HINGLISH)

Log sochte hain democracy India me British se aayi — **wrong!** Iska seedha Vedic times me hai: **Sabha, Samiti, Vidhata** jaise assemblies me collective decisions hote the. Buddha ke **Saṁghas** me voting se leader chuna jaata tha! Phir invasions aur British rule ne sab disturb kiya, but **azadi ki ladai** ne democratic ideas wapas jagaya. Result: **Constituent Assembly (1946)** ne 2 saal 11 mahine 18 din me duniya ka **longest written Constitution** banaya — full dedication! 💪

🌳 SYSTEM — INDIA KE DEMOCRATIC TRADITIONS KA SAFAR (CHRONOLOGICAL)

- **Vedic period — assemblies: Sabha, Samiti, Vidhata (collective decision-making); king ruled in consultation, not independently**
  - **Ṛig Veda 10.191.3** (Aikyamatya Sūktam) — "their counsel is one, their assembly is one, their mind is one" — consultation, consensus, shared responsibility
- **Early republican states — the gaṇas / saṁghas**
- **Bauddha Saṁghas — monastic community established by Gautama Buddha**
  - Encouraged **debate and discussion**; members chose their leader and took decisions **through voting**
- **Invasions + British colonisation (19th century) — disrupted political structures, limited people's participation**
- **Independence struggle — revived and strengthened democratic ideas among people**
- **Constituent Assembly (formed 1946) — drafted the Constitution in 2 years, 11 months, 18 days**
  - World's **longest written Constitution**; guided by the **Constituent Assembly's Debates (CAD)** and global democratic values

- Dynamic document — evolves through **amendments under Article 368** (robust, flexible, transformative, responsive)

✍️ **EXAM POINTS**

- Dr. **B.R. Ambedkar** was the Chairman of the **Drafting Committee** of the Constitution.
- Democratic ethos in India **did not emerge suddenly** — it evolved through a long historical process.

T3 Principle 1 & 2 — Popular Sovereignty + Rule of Law 👑📜

☐ revised

📖 **DEFINITIONS**

Popular sovereignty — the idea that the state derives its authority from the **people**; the ultimate source of power lies with them. | **Universal Adult Franchise** — the right of every citizen **18 years of age and above** to vote through a **secret ballot**. | **Rule of Law** — the principle that **no one is above the law**; it ensures **equality before the law** (every individual, irrespective of status, treated equally) and **equal protection of the law** (all persons in similar circumstances treated equally, without discrimination).

💡 **SAMAJH (HINGLISH)**

Do bodyguard concepts hain democracy ke: **Popular sovereignty** — "power public se aata hai" (government ki license janta renew karti hai har 5 saal me!). **Rule of Law** — "law sabke upar, sabki barabar" — minister ho ya aam aadmi, todne pe same court, same punishment. Koi bhi force ya paisa se faisla nahi kar sakta, sab **procedure established by law** se hoga — bina due process koi punish nahi ho sakta!

✍️ **EXAM POINTS**

- A government elected through **free and fair elections** formulates policies and implements laws.
- Under rule of law, disputes are resolved in a **court of law** through procedures established by law — not by force or personal influence.
- No citizen can be **punished without due process**; everyone gets a fair opportunity to defend their rights against arbitrary action.
- The rule of law promotes **justice, accountability, and trust** in the democratic system.

T4 Principle 3 — Fundamental Rights (6 FRs) 🛡️

☐ revised

📖 **DEFINITION**

Fundamental Rights — rights enshrined in the Indian Constitution that safeguard the rights, freedom, and dignity of citizens; they are **enforceable in courts of law**, **indivisible** and **inalienable**, subject to reasonable restrictions as per the procedure established by law.

💡 **SAMAJH (HINGLISH)**

Ye 6 rights democracy ke **shield** hain — articles ke saath ratto, exam me seedha poocha jata hai! Trick: **"E-F-E-R-C-C"** — Equality, Freedom, Exploitation-not, Religion, Cultural, Constitutional-Remedies. Aur **Article 32** ko Ambedkar ne "heart and soul" kaha — kyunki iske bina baaki rights enforce nahi ho sakte! Koi right todne pe **Articles 32 & 226** (Supreme Court / High Court) me ja sakte ho. Bonus: **RTE — Article 21A (2009)** — 6 se 14 saal ke bachcho ke liye free & compulsory education.

🌳 **SYSTEM — 6 FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS (ARTICLES KE SAATH)**

- **Right to Equality — Articles 14–18**
- **Right to Freedom — Articles 19–22**
- **Right Against Exploitation — Articles 23–24**
- **Right to Freedom of Religion — Articles 25–28**
- **Cultural and Educational Rights — Articles 29–30**
- **Right to Constitutional Remedies — Article 32**
  - Violations → legal action; remedies available under **Articles 32 and 226**

✍️ **EXAM POINTS**

- **Right to Education (Article 21A)** — added in **2009**; free and compulsory education for children aged **6 to 14**.
- The Constitution also outlines **Fundamental Duties** and **Directive Principles of State Policy**.

T5 Principle 4 — Separation of Powers ⚖️

☐ revised

📖 **DEFINITION**

Separation of powers — distribution of powers among the **legislature, executive, and judiciary**, each with distinct responsibilities, preventing the concentration of power in any one organ. | **PIL (Public Interest Litigation)** — a legal action initiated in a court of law for the enforcement of public interest.

💡 **SAMAJH (HINGLISH)**

Ek hi organ ke paas sab power? Dictatorship ban jayegi! Isliye 3 organs ka **division of labour**: Legislature = **law BANANE wala**, Executive = **law CHALANE wala**, Judiciary = **law SAMJHANE wala** (interpret). Aur sab ek dusre pe **nazar** rakhte hain = **checks and balances** — jaise teen dost ek project me ek dusre ki galtiyan pakadte hain! Judiciary koi law unconstitutional declare kar sakti hai, aur **PIL** ke through common man bhi court ke darwaze khat-khata sakta hai.

🌳 **SYSTEM — 3 ORGANS + CHECKS & BALANCES**

- **Legislature — makes laws (Parliament, State Assemblies)**
  - Has power to **amend the Constitution**
- **Executive — implements laws**
  - Enforcement agencies regulated by laws and rules framed by Parliament; can be reviewed by courts
- **Judiciary — interprets laws**
  - Reviews amendments for consistency with the Constitution; can declare a law **unconstitutional**; impartial and independent; safeguards rights via **PIL**

✍️ **EXAM POINTS**

- This separation is essential for maintaining **checks and balances** among the three organs of the government.
- The judiciary ensures laws enacted by Parliament and State Legislative Assemblies are **in accordance with the Constitution**.

T6 Principle 5, 6, 7 — Accountability + Multi-Party + Vulnerable Groups 🔍

☐ revised

📖 **DEFINITIONS**

Multi-party system — a system in which several political parties contest elections, representing diverse voices and interests; the party or coalition securing **more than 50 per cent of the seats** forms the government, the rest form the **opposition**. | **Civil society** — voluntary groups, NGOs and community associations that function interdependently within society.

💡 **SAMAJH (HINGLISH)**

Accountability ka funda: government **jawab-deh** hai — elections, public debates, civil society sab judge ban ke baithte hain. Sabse bada tool = **RTI Act 2005** — koi bhi citizen government departments se **information maang** sakta hai (transparency!). Multi-party system me har ideology ko apni party mil sakti hai — 2800+ registered parties India me! Aur history me weaker sections (SC/ST) ka exploitation hua hai, isliye **Article 46** unke liye special care bolta hai.

✍️ **EXAM POINTS**

- Through **elections, public debates, and engagement with civil society**, citizens evaluate the government's actions — this builds trust.
- **RTI Act, 2005** — allows citizens to seek information from government agencies; enacted through democratic processes (reviewed by expert groups, debated in Parliament, safeguards for national security).
- Political parties function within the framework of the **Representation of the People Act, 1951**.
- **Article 46** — the State shall promote with special care the educational and economic interests of weaker sections, especially **Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes**, and protect them from social injustice and exploitation.
- **Question Hour** — first hour of a parliamentary session when members ask questions to the government, checking its work (accountability).

T7 Process → Institution → Value Table 🏛️

☐ revised

💡 **SAMAJH (HINGLISH)**

Ye table **"kaam → kaun karta hai → kya value nikalti hai"** ka combo hai. Exam me "how democratic processes are supported by institutions" poocha jaye toh **seedha ye table** likh do! Jaise law-making = Legislature ka kaam, aur usse nikalti hain Representation + Deliberation + Dissent ke values. Ratto — 3-column yaad: Process | Institutions | Values!

Process	Institutions	Democratic Values
Legislative	Legislature (Parliament, State legislature, Local bodies)	Representation, Deliberation, Dissent
Electoral	Election Commission of India	Participation, Equality
Judicial	Courts	Rule of law, Equality, Justice
Participatory	Media, Civil Society	Debate and discussion, Freedom of expression
Accountability	CAG, CIC, Lokpal, CVC	Transparency
Decentralisation	Rural and Urban local bodies	People's participation at grassroots level
Checks and Balances	Division of powers between centre and states (written constitution)	Devolution of power

✍ EXAM POINTS

- **Media** is often called the **'fourth pillar of democracy'** — keeps people informed and serves as the voice of the masses.
- **Don't Miss Out:** the real strength of democracy lies in its **citizens** — participation, awareness of duties and rights, and commitment to honesty and fairness.

T8 Types of Democracy — 4 Models 🌍

☐ revised

📖 DEFINITION

Democracy does not offer a single model of government — different societies institutionalise it in diverse ways, depending on how citizens participate in decision-making and how political power is structured.

💡 SAMAJH (HINGLISH)

School wala example yaad karo: **Team A** (sab students vote karte hain bade decisions pe — direct democracy lite), **Team B** (class rep chunta hai president — indirect/representative), **Team C** (students president + council dono chunte hain, president boss — presidential feel), **Team D** (selected candidates hi contest kar sakti hain, president ke paas saara power — democracy sirf naam ka!). Ye hi duniya ke 4 models hain. India = **Parliamentary** (PM + council of ministers, accountable to legislature), USA = **Presidential**, Switzerland = **Direct**!

🌳 SYSTEM — TYPES OF DEMOCRACY (ISKE UNDER KYA)

- **Direct Democracy — e.g., Switzerland**
  - Citizens **directly participate** in most decision-making processes
  - Some features of representative democracy also exist
  - **Difficult to follow in large countries**
- **Representative (Indirect) Democracy — e.g., India**
  - People **elect representatives**; they do not directly govern
  - Periodic elections; government accountable to the people
  - Two sub-models:
    - **Parliamentary** — e.g., India, Canada: executive members are **part of the legislature**; executive accountable to the legislature; people elect the legislature, not the executive
    - **Presidential** — e.g., USA: executive is **independent of the legislature**; President elected by the people, accountable to the people

Country	Type	Head of State / Govt	Key Features
India	Representative (Parliamentary)	President (HoS) + PM (HoG)	Multi-party, written constitution, FRs & Duties, federalism
Canada	Representative (Parliamentary)	Governor-General (Crown of UK) + PM	Federalism, multi-party system
UK	Parliamentary with Constitutional Monarchy	Monarch (HoS) + PM (HoG)	Unwritten constitution, parliamentary sovereignty, multi-party
Switzerland	Direct	President (HoG); Federal Council holds executive power	Written constitution, multiple parties
USA	Representative (Presidential)	President (HoG)	Written constitution, two major parties

✍ EXAM POINTS — 2 IMPORTANT DEFINITIONS

- **Federalism** — a system in which power and responsibilities are shared between the central and state governments, as expressed in the **central, state and concurrent lists**; residual power remains with the central government.
- **Sovereignty** — from Latin **superanus** ('supreme'); the supreme, final, and independent legal authority of a State over its territory and citizens.

T9 India's Living Democracy — Scale + Women + Grassroots 📊

☐ revised

💡 SAMAJH (HINGLISH)

India ki democracy "living" kyun? **Scale dekho:** 96.8 crore voters, ek MP ~25 lakh logon ko represent karta hai, 22 scheduled languages me elections, **1 million+ polling stations** — jungle, pahad, desert, island sab me (kahin kahin **1 voter** ke liye bhi booth!). Women ke case me India **ahead** tha — Britain (1928) aur USA (1920) me women ne vote ke liye ladhna pada, but India ne **1950 me hi sabko** Universal Adult Franchise de diya, bina ladai! Aur grassroots pe **Panchayati Raj** — villages me hi self-government (village = unit of grassroots democracy).

🌳 SYSTEM — FACTS THAT MAKE INDIA'S DEMOCRACY "LIVING"

- **Scale: 96.8 crore+ registered voters (2024) — more people vote in India than the total population of many countries**
- **Representation: on average one MP represents about 25 lakh people**

- **Languages: elections conducted in 22 scheduled languages; election symbols let even those who cannot read vote independently**
- **Reach: over one million polling stations (mountains, forests, deserts, islands) — sometimes for a single voter**
- **Parties: over 2,800 registered political parties — social and regional diversity, many viewpoints compete peacefully**

✍️ **EXAM POINTS — WOMEN & GRASSROOTS (ARTICLES IMPORTANT!)**

- **Women & the right to vote:** Britain — full voting rights only in **1928**; USA — **1920**, after decades of protests. In India, the Constitution (in force **1950**) extended **Universal Adult Franchise to all citizens — men and women alike**, without prolonged battles — though social prejudices still limit women's equal representation.
- **Article 243(d)** — not less than **one-third** seats reserved for women in every Panchayat (by direct election); **21 States + 2 UTs** have gone to **50%** in Panchayati Raj Institutions.
- **Article 243(t)** — not less than one-third for women in every Municipality; as of 2023, **17 States + 1 UT** have 50% in Urban Local Bodies.
- **Three-tier system:** Union, State and Local governments; **Autonomous District Councils (ADCs)** in north-eastern regions (legislative + judicial authority to preserve tribal customs); **PESA Act, 1996** — Panchayats Extension to Scheduled Areas, empowers the **Gram Sabha** as the primary decision-making body.
- **Case studies: Jethipura Gram Panchayat** (Gujarat) — Nanaji Deshmukh Rashtriya Gaurav Gram Sabha Puraskar, **2019** (special Gram Sabhas, Mahila Sabhas, quorum, SC/ST & women's participation); **South Manubankul Gram Panchayat** (Tripura) — recognised as a **"women-friendly panchayat"** by the Ministry of Panchayati Raj.
- **Quorum** — the minimum number of members needed in an assembly meeting to make proceedings valid; **Cooperatives** — groups formed by people to work together for common benefit, sharing profits and responsibilities equally.
- **Participatory democracy** — citizens' involvement beyond elections: local councils, public consultations, community-driven initiatives. Grassroots leaders: **Chaudhary Charan Singh, Babu Jagjivan Ram** (advocated for the rural poor and marginalised).

T10 Challenges + Emergency (1975–77) ⚠️

☐ revised

📖 **DEFINITION**

Emergency — a special constitutional provision; **Articles 352, 356 and 360** of the Constitution deal with **National Emergency, President's Rule, and Financial Emergency** respectively.

💡 **SAMAJH (HINGLISH)**

Democracy ko maintenance chahiye! Challenges: **illiteracy, fake news** (social media se failti hai), **poverty, regionalism, gender inequality, social discrimination**, aur laws ke implementation me gaps. Sabse bada test tha **Emergency 1975–77**: Indira Gandhi ki government ke against bhaari protest (unemployment, inflation, misgovernance) → **June 1975 me National Emergency** lag gayi (ground: internal disturbance) → **Fundamental Rights suspend, press censorship**, neta activists jail me! **Jayaprakash Narayan (Lok Nayak)** ne Bihar-Gujarat me students aur citizens mobilise kiye. 1977 me Emergency hatai, elections hue, ruling government **haari** — proof ki democracy ki asli taqat: janta boss hai!

✍️ **EXAM POINTS**

- Democracy requires **constant care, awareness, and active participation** from both institutions and citizens.
- Actions like **damaging public property, spreading misinformation, or violating public rules** weaken democratic values; indifference towards public issues also hurts democracy.
- **Emergency timeline:** early 1970s — public dissatisfaction (rising unemployment, inflation, allegations of misgovernance) → **June 1975: National Emergency** imposed on grounds of internal disturbance → Fundamental Rights suspended, press censored, political leaders and activists arrested → mass movements led by **Jayaprakash Narayan (Lok Nayak)**, especially in Bihar and Gujarat → **1977: Emergency lifted**, general elections held → ruling government defeated.
- The episode showed both the **vulnerabilities and the resilience** of Indian democracy — the power of the ballot.
- **Civic responsibility** — respecting others' rights, using social media responsibly, abiding by laws, appreciating diversity, participating in activities that strengthen unity.

T11 Democracy and You — Young Citizen's Toolkit 🎒

☐ revised

💡 **SAMAJH (HINGLISH)**

Tum bhi democracy ka part ho! Formula: **informed raho** (newspaper, news, responsible internet use — fake news se door!), **Constitution samjho, fundamental duties follow karo**, school aur community me **leadership lo**, aur nation-building activities join karo — **NSS, NCC, Bharat Scouts & Guides**. Chhote steps bhi count karte hain — democracy sirf election day nahi, **roz ka practice** hai!

✍️ **EXAM POINTS — BEFORE WE MOVE ON (BOOK SUMMARY)**

- Democracy is a system of **self-governance** involving institutions, rules and practices for participation at local, state and national levels — **not limited to elections alone**.
- Democratic processes are guided by **transparency, participation, inclusion, fairness, equality, accountability, and respect for diverse opinions**.
- Democratic ideas in India have deep roots in ancient traditions (**Sabhā and Samiti** in Vedic texts) — consultation and collective decision-making.

- India's democracy rests on the Constitution: **popular sovereignty, universal adult franchise, fundamental rights and duties, rule of law, separation of powers**.
- India is the world's largest democracy due to the **scale of citizen participation** — though challenges remain in deeper inclusion and representation.
- Citizens contribute through **civic awareness, responsible media use, community participation**, and respect for democratic values in everyday life.
- Programmes like **NSS and NCC** instil civic responsibility, social awareness and respect for democratic ideals.

⚖️ Differences — Pakka Aane Wale

Basis	Direct Democracy	Representative (Indirect) Democracy
Who decides	Citizens **directly participate** in most decision-making	Citizens elect **representatives** who take decisions on their behalf
People's role	Direct voting on policies and laws	People do not directly govern; periodic elections hold the government accountable
Feasibility	**Difficult in large countries**	Works well for large, diverse countries
Example	Switzerland	India (parliamentary), USA (presidential)

Basis	Parliamentary Democracy	Presidential Democracy
Executive	Members of the executive are **also part of the legislature**	The executive is **independent of the legislature**
Accountability	Executive is accountable to the **legislature**	President is accountable to the **people**
Who people elect	The **legislature** (not the executive directly)	The **President** directly
Examples	India, Canada	United States of America

📖 Definition Bank — Chapter 6 (likhne ke liye ready)

Democracy — form of government where power lies with the citizens, who elect representatives through free and fair elections.

Universal Adult Franchise — right of every citizen 18+ to vote by secret ballot.

Fundamental Rights — six enforceable, indivisible, inalienable rights (Art 14–32) safeguarding freedom and dignity.

Checks and balances — each organ checks the others, preventing concentration of power.

Civil society — voluntary groups, NGOs and community associations within society.

Question Hour — first hour of a parliamentary session for members' questions to the government.

Sovereignty — supreme, final, independent legal authority of a State (Latin: superanus).

Representative democracy — people elect representatives to govern (India).

Cooperatives — groups working together for common benefit, sharing profits and responsibilities.

PESA Act 1996 — extends Panchayats to Scheduled Areas; Gram Sabha = primary decision-making body.

Civic responsibility — respecting rights, responsible social media, obeying laws, strengthening unity.

Popular sovereignty — the state derives its authority from the people; ultimate power lies with them.

Rule of law — no one is above the law; equality before law + equal protection of law.

Separation of powers — legislature makes laws, executive implements, judiciary interprets.

PIL — Public Interest Litigation; legal action for enforcement of public interest.

Multi-party system — several parties contest; >50% seats forms the government, rest = opposition.

Federalism — power shared between central and state governments (central/state/concurrent lists).

Direct democracy — citizens directly participate in most decision-making (Switzerland).

Quorum — minimum members required to validate assembly proceedings.

ADCs — Autonomous District Councils in north-east; legislative & judicial authority for tribal customs.

Emergency — Art 352 (National), Art 356 (President's Rule), Art 360 (Financial).

Participatory democracy — citizen engagement beyond elections: councils, consultations, community initiatives.

✅ MCQ Challenge — 10 Questions (Ch 6)

🎯 Solve karne ke baad score bharo → ____ / 10

Q1. In a democracy, the source of power and authority lies with —

a) the President
b) the Parliament
c) the citizens of the country
d) the judiciary

Q2. The Constitution of India was adopted on —

a) 26 January 1950
b) 26 November 1949
c) 15 August 1947
d) 26 January 1949

Q3. The assemblies of the Vedic period that involved collective decision-making were —

a Sabha, Samiti and Vidhata
b Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha
c Gram Sabha and Mahila Sabha
d ADCs and PESA

Q4. How long did the Constituent Assembly take to draft the Constitution?

a 2 years, 11 months, 18 days
b 3 years, 6 months
c 11 months
d 5 years

Q5. The Right to Constitutional Remedies is guaranteed by —

a Article 21A
b Article 32
c Article 46
d Article 368

Q6. Which organ of the government interprets the laws?

a Legislature
b Executive
c Judiciary
d Election Commission

Q7. The Right to Information (RTI) Act, which empowers citizens to seek information from government agencies, was enacted in —

a 1950
b 1975
c 2005
d 2009

Q8. Which country practises direct democracy?

a India
b United States of America
c Switzerland
d Canada

Q9. In which of these countries did women have to struggle the longest to get full voting rights?

a India (1950)
b USA (1920)
c Britain (1928)
d Switzerland

Q10. During the Emergency of 1975–77, the mass movements mobilising students and citizens were led by —

a Mahatma Gandhi
b Jayaprakash Narayan (Lok Nayak)
c Dr. B.R. Ambedkar
d Chaudhary Charan Singh

🔑 Answer Key — Chapter 6

1 → c | 2 → b | 3 → a | 4 → a | 5 → b | 6 → c | 7 → c | 8 → c | 9 → c | 10 → b

- **1:** Democracy = power and authority with the citizens, through free and fair elections.
- **2:** Adopted 26 November 1949; came into force 26 January 1950.
- **3:** Vedic assemblies: Sabha, Samiti, Vidhata — collective decision-making.
- **4:** 2 years, 11 months and 18 days — the world's longest written Constitution.
- **5:** Article 32 (remedies also under Article 226); called the heart and soul of the Constitution.
- **6:** Judiciary interprets laws; legislature makes them; executive implements them.
- **7:** RTI Act came into force in 2005 — a key accountability and transparency law.
- **8:** Switzerland — citizens directly participate in most decisions; India/USA are representative.
- **9:** Britain — women got full voting rights only in 1928 (USA: 1920; India: granted in 1950 without struggle).
- **10:** Jayaprakash Narayan — 'Lok Nayak', mobilised students and citizens in Bihar and Gujarat.

📝 Big Questions — Exam-Ready Answers (Ch 6)

Q1. What is democracy? Explain its meaning and foundational principles.

ANSWER

- Democracy is a form of government in which the **source of power and authority lies with the citizens**, who elect their representatives through **free and fair elections**.
- It is founded on the principles of **freedom, equality, justice, rights and duties**.

- Citizens have the right to **vote, express their opinions, and participate in decision-making processes**.
- India is the world's largest democracy — population over **140 crore** and a voter base of over **96.8 crore (2024)**.
- The Constitution guarantees and protects the Fundamental Rights of all citizens without discrimination based on religion, race, caste, sex, or place of birth.

Q2. Trace the evolution of democratic traditions in India from early times.

ANSWER

- The idea of democracy has been part of the Indian ethos since early times — the Vedic assemblies **Sabha, Samiti and Vidhata** involved collective decision-making.
- The king was not an independent ruler but worked in consultation with assemblies, ministers and officers.
- The **Aikyamatya Sūktam of the Ṛig Veda (10.191.3)** emphasises collective thinking, shared discussion and unity of purpose.
- The **Bauddha Saṁghas** established by Gautama Buddha encouraged debate and discussion; members could **choose their leader and decide through voting**.
- Invasions and British colonisation disrupted political structures, but the **independence struggle revived democratic ideas**.
- The **Constituent Assembly (1946)** drafted the world's longest written Constitution in 2 years, 11 months and 18 days.

Q3. Explain popular sovereignty and the rule of law as principles of democracy.

ANSWER

- **Popular sovereignty:** the ultimate source of power lies with the people; the state derives its authority from them.
- A government elected through free and fair elections formulates policies and implements laws.
- Every citizen **18 years and above** has the right to vote through a secret ballot — the **Universal Adult Franchise**.
- **Rule of law:** ensures **equality before the law** and **equal protection of the law**; no one is above the law.
- Disputes are resolved in courts through procedures established by law — not by force or influence; no citizen can be punished without **due process**.
- Together they promote justice, accountability and public trust in the democratic system.

Q4. List the six Fundamental Rights given in the Constitution with their Articles.

ANSWER

- **Right to Equality** — Articles 14–18.
- **Right to Freedom** — Articles 19–22.
- **Right Against Exploitation** — Articles 23–24.
- **Right to Freedom of Religion** — Articles 25–28.
- **Cultural and Educational Rights** — Articles 29–30.
- **Right to Constitutional Remedies** — Article 32.
- These rights are **enforceable in courts of law, indivisible and inalienable**, subject to reasonable restrictions; remedies can be sought under **Articles 32 and 226**; the **Right to Education (Article 21A, added 2009)** gives free and compulsory education to children aged 6–14.

Q5. What is the separation of powers? How does it maintain checks and balances?

ANSWER

- Separation of powers distributes responsibilities among the **legislature, executive and judiciary** so that each functions effectively and responsibly.
- The **legislature makes laws**, the **executive implements them**, and the **judiciary interprets them** — preventing the concentration of power in any one organ.
- Example: Parliament can **amend the Constitution**, but the judiciary can **review amendments** for consistency with the Constitution.
- The executive's enforcement powers are regulated by laws framed by Parliament and can be reviewed by courts.
- If a law is inconsistent with constitutional provisions, the judiciary can declare it **unconstitutional**.
- The judiciary also upholds rights through initiatives like **Public Interest Litigation (PIL)**.

Q6. How is the government kept accountable and transparent in a democracy? Explain with examples.

ANSWER

- Democratic governments are accountable to citizens through **elections, public debates, and engagement with civil society**.
- **Question Hour** — the first hour of a parliamentary session — lets members question the government and hold it accountable.
- The **Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005** allows citizens to seek information from government agencies — a major transparency law.
- Accountability bodies include the **CAG, Central Information Commission (CIC), Lokpal and Central Vigilance Commission (CVC)**.
- Media and civil society act as the **fourth pillar**, raising public issues and enabling freedom of expression.
- Decentralisation through **rural and urban local bodies** ensures people's participation at the grassroots level.

Q7. Describe the different types of democracy practised around the world, with examples.

ANSWER

- **Direct democracy** — citizens directly participate in most decision-making; some representative features exist; difficult in large countries — e.g., **Switzerland**.
- **Representative (indirect) democracy** — people elect representatives; periodic elections; government accountable — e.g., **India**.
- **Parliamentary democracy** — executive members are part of the legislature; executive accountable to the legislature; people elect the legislature — e.g., **India, Canada** (UK adds a constitutional monarchy).
- **Presidential democracy** — executive independent of the legislature; President elected by the people and accountable to them — e.g., **USA**.
- Different societies institutionalise democracy in diverse ways, depending on citizen participation and how political power is structured.

Q8. What makes India a 'living democracy'? Explain with facts and figures.

ANSWER

- India's democracy stands out for its **scale, depth and inclusiveness** — nearly a hundred crore voters form an unparalleled exercise in public participation.
- In 2024, India had over **96.8 crore registered voters** — more than the total population of many countries.
- On average, one **Member of Parliament represents about 25 lakh people**.
- Elections are conducted in **22 scheduled languages**; **election symbols** allow even those who cannot read to vote independently.
- Over **one million polling stations** are set up, including remote mountains, forests, deserts and islands — sometimes for a single voter.
- Over **2,800 registered political parties** reflect India's social and regional diversity, letting many viewpoints compete peacefully.
- A three-tier system (Union, State, Local), ADCs and the PESA Act extend democracy to the grassroots.

Q9. Compare the Indian experience of women's right to vote with that of Britain and the USA. What reservation exists in local bodies?

ANSWER

- In many countries, women had to launch long struggles: in **Britain**, full voting rights came only in **1928**; in the **USA**, in **1920**, after decades of protests.
- In contrast, when the Constitution came into force in **1950**, Indian women were granted **Universal Adult Franchise without any prolonged legal battle**.
- However, the right to vote does not automatically ensure equal participation — **social prejudices** still limit women's representation.
- **Article 243(d)**: not less than **one-third** of seats in every Panchayat are reserved for women; **21 States + 2 UTs** provide **50%** reservation.
- **Article 243(t)**: not less than one-third in every Municipality; as of 2023, **17 States + 1 UT** have 50% in Urban Local Bodies.
- Case studies like **South Manubankul (Tripura)** — the 'women-friendly panchayat' — show women's participation in action.

Q10. What challenges does Indian democracy face? Describe the Emergency of 1975–77.

ANSWER

- Challenges include **illiteracy, misinformation and fake news** (especially via social media), **poverty, regionalism, gender inequality and social discrimination**.
- Gaps in the implementation of laws and policies reduce public trust; damaging public property and indifference also weaken democracy.
- **Emergency background:** in the early 1970s, public dissatisfaction with the Indira Gandhi government grew due to rising unemployment, inflation and allegations of misgovernance.
- In **June 1975**, a National Emergency was imposed on grounds of internal disturbance — Fundamental Rights were suspended, the press censored, and political leaders and activists arrested.
- Mass movements led by **Jayaprakash Narayan ('Lok Nayak')** mobilised students and citizens, especially in Bihar and Gujarat.
- The Emergency was lifted in **1977**; elections followed and the ruling government was **defeated** — proving the strength of the ballot and the resilience of Indian democracy.
- **Articles 352, 356 and 360** deal with National Emergency, President's Rule and Financial Emergency respectively.

CHAPTER 7 • CIVICS

Elections

Elections = democracy ka **dil**. Is chapter me: elections kyun zaroori hain, FPTP vs PR systems, election ke laws (RP Acts), ECI ki poori machinery, political parties ka role, anti-defection law, aur challenges — sab systems ke saath!



🔑 10 Topics | 📖 25+ Definitions | 🌳 5 System Trees | ✅ 10 MCQs | 📝 10 Q&A

📚 Notes — Har Topic, Poori Samajh

T1 Why Elections Matter — 4 Values 🗳️

☐ revised

📖 DEFINITIONS

Election — a process through which we exercise the **right to vote** and fulfil our responsibility as citizens. | **Direct elections** — citizens vote directly to choose their representatives or leaders. | **Indirect elections** — citizens vote for representatives who then choose/elect the leaders.

💡 SAMAJH (HINGLISH)

Simple sawal: CR (class rep) ko bina election agle saal bhi CR rahne denge? Nahi! Wahi government ke saath hai — **periodic elections** democracy ka core hai. Ek hi party ho toh choice kya? Fair nahi! Election se milne wali 4 values ratto: **Equality** (sabki vote barabar), **Representation** (har awaaz pahunchti hai), **Accountability** (nikal sakte hain!), **Legitimacy** (janta ka mandate = asli license). Bonus word: **psephology** — Greek *psēphos* (pebble — ancient Greece me voting ke liye!) + logy = scientific study of elections.

🌳 SYSTEM — DIRECT VS INDIRECT ELECTIONS (KISME KYA)

- **Direct elections — every 5 years**
  - **Lok Sabha** (central level)
  - **Vidhan Sabha** (Legislative Assembly, state level)
  - **Local bodies** — Panchayats, municipal corporations, etc.
- **Indirect elections**
  - The **President** of India
  - The **Vice President**
  - Members of the **Rajya Sabha**

✍️ EXAM POINTS

- **Regular and periodic elections lie at the core of democracy** — representatives are chosen through direct or indirect elections.
- Elected representatives are **accountable to the people**; our **vote is the principal means** of exercising this right.
- The government cannot continue beyond its prescribed term without seeking the people's mandate again.
- Elections give every citizen an **equal voice** in the formation of a government — they are the soul of democracy.

T2 The Electoral System — FPTP vs Majority vs PR 🧱

☐ revised

📖 DEFINITION

Electoral system — the method of converting the votes cast into seats in the legislature; the way a system allocates seats distinguishes it from others. Our Constitution framers chose the **plurality system or 'First-Past-The-Post' (FPTP)**.

💡 SAMAJH (HINGLISH)

Race ka concept: **FPTP** = **race ki finishing line pe jo first aaya, wahi winner** — chahe 40% hi vote mile ho! (Haritbhumi me Party A 40% pe jeet gayi). **Majority system** = 50%+ chahiye, warna **round 2** top-2 me (Ratnadweep me Party Y ne 55% se jeeta). **PR (Proportional Representation)** = **party ko vote do**, seats vote-share ke hisaab se (Swarnalok me 40% = 40 seats). India me **Lok Sabha + Vidhan Sabha = FPTP**, but **Rajya Sabha + President + VP = PR**. Simple!

Feature	First Past The Post (FPTP)	Majority System	Proportional Representation (PR)
How it works	Each voter votes for one candidate in their constituency; candidate with the **most votes wins**, even with less than 50%	Candidate needs **more than 50%**; if not, the **top two compete in a second round**	Voters vote for a **party**, not a person; seats allotted **in proportion** to total votes

Sample	Party A: 40%, B: 35%, C: 25%	Round 1: X 45%, Y 40%, Z 15%	M: 40%, N: 35%, O: 15%, P: 10%
Result	Party A forms the government	Round 2: Y wins with 55%	Seats: M-40, N-35, O-15, P-10 — power shared proportionately
Used in India for	**Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha**	Not used in India	**Rajya Sabha, President, Vice President**

✍️ **EXAM POINTS**

- FPTP is also called the **plurality system** — chosen by the framers of our Constitution after discussing the two most common systems.

T3 Vidhan Parishad + Single Transferable Vote 🏛️

☐ revised

💡 **SAMAJH (HINGLISH)**

6 states me legislature ka "double floor" hai — Vidhan Parishad (Upper House, Legislative Council) + Vidhan Sabha (Lower House). Parishad ka composition interesting hai: **Vidhan Sabha members + local bodies + graduates + teachers** ke vote se, aur **Governor ke nominated** members (art, science, social service, literature, co-operatives ke log). Aur STV (Single Transferable Vote) ka logic: preference mark karo (1, 2, 3...), jo candidate **quota** poora kare wahi jeeta; sabse kam wala bahar, uske votes **2nd preference** pe transfer!

🌳 **SYSTEM — VIDHAN PARISHAD (LEGISLATIVE COUNCIL) KA COMPOSITION**

- **Elected members**
  - By members of the **Vidhan Sabha**
  - By **local bodies**
  - By **graduates** and **teachers** of the State
- **Nominated members — by the Governor, from fields like art, science, social service, literature, and co-operatives**
- **Bicameral states (6): Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Telangana, Uttar Pradesh**
- **Elections to the Vidhan Parishad use proportional representation by single transferable vote**

✍️ **EXAM POINTS — STV KA PROCESS (STEPS)**

1. Voters **mark their preferences** (1st, 2nd, 3rd...) on the ballot.
2. **First preference votes** are counted for all candidates; those who reach the **quota** (minimum votes needed to win) are declared elected.
3. The candidate with the **lowest votes is eliminated**; their votes are **transferred** to the second preferences marked on those ballots.
4. The process continues till the required number of candidates are elected.

🧮 **Quota formula: Quota = Total valid votes ÷ (Seats to be filled + 1)** — the minimum votes required to win.

T4 The Laws — RP Act 1950 & 1951 📜

☐ revised

💡 **SAMAJH (HINGLISH)**

Election ke 2 kadhai (main laws): **RP Act 1950** = **"set-up wala"** — seats ka allocation, constituency boundaries (delimitation), electoral rolls banana, 18+ sabko vote ka right. **RP Act 1951** = **"conduct wala"** — nomination, campaign, voting procedure, disputes — sab rules. Plus **Presidential and Vice-Presidential Act, 1952**. Corrupt practices strictly banned: **rishwat** (gift/promise for vote), **religion/caste ke naam pe vote maangna**, aur **government officials ki madad lena** — teeno offences hain!

🌳 **SYSTEM — ELECTION LAWS (KYA KARTA HAI KAUNSA)**

- **Representation of the People Act, 1950**
  - Allocation of seats and **delimitation of constituencies**
  - Preparation and **revision of electoral rolls**
  - Ensuring every citizen **above 18 years** can vote without discrimination
- **Representation of the People Act, 1951**
  - All other aspects of the **conduct of elections** and **post-election disputes**
  - Rules for **nomination of candidates, election campaigns, voting procedures, and dispute resolution**
  - Lists **electoral offences and corrupt practices**
- **The Presidential and Vice-Presidential Act, 1952**
- **Corrupt practices (banned): bribery (gift/offer/promise to make someone contest, withdraw or vote); appealing for votes on religion, caste, race, community or language; taking help of government personnel (gazetted officers, judges, magistrates, armed forces, police, excise officers)**

✍️ **EXAM POINTS**

- Together these Acts ensure the **integrity, transparency and accountability** of India's electoral process.

T5 Delimitation Commission 🗺️

☐ revised

📖 DEFINITION

Delimitation — the process of determining the **number of seats** and fixing the **territorial boundaries** in each state for elections to the Lok Sabha and the Vidhan Sabha, so that the ratio of seats to population is as close to equal as possible across all constituencies.

💡 SAMAJH (HINGLISH)

Constituency ki boundaries **permanent nahi** hain! Population shift hoti rehti hai — bina delimitation ke ek MP **5 lakh** logon ko represent karta aur doosra **25 lakh** ko... unfair na? Isliye time-time pe boundaries re-draw hoti hain. **Article 82** ke under Delimitation Commission banta hai; India me **4 commissions** hue hain: **1952, 1963, 1973, 2002**. (1973 aur 2002 ke beech bada gap — population control se related interesting story!)

✍️ EXAM POINTS

- Boundaries of parliamentary and assembly constituencies **change over time** depending on shifts in population density.
- Without delimitation, equal representation is defeated — one MP might represent five lakh people while another represents twenty-five lakh.
- **Article 82** of the Constitution mandates the establishment of a Delimitation Commission.
- India has had **four Delimitation Commissions: 1952, 1963, 1973 and 2002**.

T6 ECI — Structure & State Machinery 🏢

☐ revised

📖 DEFINITION

Election Commission of India (ECI) — an **autonomous, permanent constitutional body** (established **25 January 1950**) vested with the **superintendence, direction, and control** of the entire process for the conduct of elections. **Articles 324 to 329** of the Constitution provide for its establishment and define its powers and duties.

💡 SAMAJH (HINGLISH)

Election ka **referee** = ECI! Independent boss hai — kisi party ka nahi sunta, sirf Constitution ka. Kab bana? **25 January 1950** (isliye National Voters' Day bhi isi din!). Kaam: Lok Sabha, Rajya Sabha, Vidhan Sabha, Vidhan Parishad, President aur Vice President — **sabki elections** conduct karta hai. State level pe machinery: **CEO (Chief Electoral Officer)** boss, aur DMs/SDMs/Tahsildars ko election duty pe designations milti hain — DEO, RO, ERO. Poora system — har level pe officers ready!

🌳 SYSTEM — ELECTION MACHINERY (KIS LEVEL PE KAUN)

- **ECI (national level) — superintendence, direction and control of the entire election process**
- **State level — Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) of the State**
  - Appointed by the ECI from among civil servants, in consultation with the State Government
- **District level & below — State Government officers assigned election duties**
  - District Magistrates, Sub-Divisional Magistrates, Tahsildars → designated as **District Election Officers (DEO)**, **Returning Officers (RO)**, **Electoral Registration Officers (ERO)**

✍️ EXAM POINTS

- For democracy to be realised, elections must be conducted in a **free, fair and transparent** manner.
- The Constitution and parliamentary laws define the functions and powers of all stakeholders: the **ECI, political parties, civil society, media, and voters**.

T7 ECI — 4 Main Functions 🛠️

☐ revised

💡 SAMAJH (HINGLISH)

ECI ke 4 bade kaam: **(1) Electoral roll banana** — har ghar me enumerator bhej ke voters ki list; **SIR** (Special Intensive Revision) se list saaf-suthri — naye 18+ wale add, dead/shifted/duplicate hatao! **(2) Schedule decide karna** — kab election? Mausam, fasal ka cycle, exams, festivals — sab dekh ke. **(3) Parties register karna + symbols dena** — national/state/RUPP classification. **(4) Free & fair ensure karna** — sabko include karo: PwDs, 85+ senior citizens (ghar pe vote!), EVM me Braille. "No Voter to Be Left Behind!"

🌳 SYSTEM — ECI FUNCTIONS (DETAIL ME)

- **1. Creates the electoral roll**
  - Official **enumerators** visit every household to collect data on eligible electors
  - Rolls prepared **constituency-wise, organised polling station-wise**; only those on the roll can vote
  - **SIR (Special Intensive Revision)** — updating, verifying, correcting rolls: adds young voters who just turned 18; deletes names of voters who died, shifted, enrolled twice, or are untraceable
  - Time given for **claims and objections** before the final roll is published
- **2. Decides the schedule and dates**
  - Activated when the 5-year term ends or the legislature is **dissolved early**

- Considers: **weather conditions, agricultural cycle, school/university exams, festivals**

- **3. Registers political parties & allocates symbols**
  - Only parties **registered with the ECI** can contest; independent candidates can also contest
  - Insists on **inner-party democracy** (periodic organisational elections)
  - Classifies parties: **recognised national / state-regional / registered-unrecognised**
  - Acts as a **quasi-judicial body** in disputes over party recognition and symbol allotment
- **4. Ensures free and fair elections**
  - Inclusive initiatives for **PwDs, senior citizens, transgender persons, PVTGs**
  - **Voting from home** for senior citizens **above 85** and PwDs with **40%+ benchmark disability** — extended across India for the first time in the **2024 General Elections**
  - **EVMs with Braille** for visually impaired voters

✍️ EXAM POINTS

- **National Voters' Day — 25 January** every year (ECI's foundation day), with a voters' pledge: to vote in every election **fearlessly and without being influenced by religion, race, caste, community, language or any inducement**.
- India's electoral exercise is **unparalleled** — over **96.8 crore** eligible voters (2024) across diverse regions and terrains; the ECI uses ICT and e-governance extensively.

T8 ECI Digital Ecosystem — Apps 📱

☐ revised

💡 SAMAJH (HINGLISH)

ECI ek **tech-savvy boss** hai — har problem ka ek app! Service voters (army etc.) ke liye **ETPBS** (electronically ballot ghar bhejo), voters ke liye **Helpline App**, violation report karne ke liye **cVIGIL** (flying squads turant pahunchti hain!), forms ke liye **ERONET**, election vehicles ke liye **Sugam**, candidates ke liye **Suvidha** (permissions etc.), aur PwDs ke liye **Saksham**. International level pe bhi boss: **IEVP** programme — 28 EMBs + 3 international organisations ke saath MoUs!

🌳 SYSTEM — DIGITAL ECOSYSTEM (APP → KAAM)

- **ETPBS — Electronically Transmitted Postal Ballot System for service voters; cast votes from anywhere outside their constituency**
- **Voter Helpline App — multipurpose: registration, transposition, verification, election news and updates**
- **cVIGIL App — report Model Code of Conduct violations and misconduct in minutes; flying squads navigate to the spot via auto-location**
- **ERONET — seamless form processing, dashboards, role-based access, maintenance of e-rolls**
- **Sugam — manages vehicles requisitioned from other departments for election work**
- **Suvidha — for candidates and parties: nomination forms, permissions (meetings, rallies, vehicles, loudspeakers) with real-time status**
- **Saksham App — customised services for PwDs: registration, finding polling stations**

✍️ EXAM POINTS

- Motto: **"No Voter to Be Left Behind"**.
- **IEVP (International Election Visitors' Programme)** — flagship ECI programme for cooperation with Election Management Bodies (EMBs) of other countries; MoUs signed with **28 EMBs** and three international organisations — **IFES, International IDEA, and the United Nations**.

T9 Political Parties + Defection + Recognition 🎭

☐ revised

📖 DEFINITIONS

Defection — abandoning or switching from the political party under whose banner a candidate was **elected**; may involve joining another party or acting independently of the party's decisions (e.g., voting in the legislature). | **Whip** — the party's instruction on how to vote in the House.

💡 SAMAJH (HINGLISH)

Parties = **bridge between janta aur government**. Kaam: voters ko **informed choice** dena, public opinion organise karna, issues pe campaign, meaningful options dena. Lekin drama bhi hai: **defection** — ticket jeetne ke baad party chhodna ("party-hopping")! Isliye **Anti-Defection Law (1985, 52nd Constitutional Amendment)** aayi: party chhodo ya **whip ke against vote** karo → **disqualification**; decision **Speaker/Chairman** ka. Alliances ka bhi pattern: 1967 se single-party era khatam, **1977 me Janata Party** (first coalition), phir **NDA vs UPA** (2023 me UPA → INDIA alliance reconstitute hui).

🌳 SYSTEM — ROLE OF POLITICAL PARTIES + RECOGNITION CRITERIA

- **Functions: enable voters to make informed decisions; organise public opinion; campaign on specific issues; offer voters meaningful choices**
- **Flow: Citizens → Political Parties (organise opinion, contest elections, plan campaigns, prepare manifestos)**
  - **Winning party** — forms the government; formulates and implements policies; ensures accountability
  - **Opposition parties** — participate in debates and committees; hold the government accountable
- **Party recognition (by ECI):**
  - **National party** — any one: 6% valid votes in **4+ states** + 4 Lok Sabha seats; OR **2% of LS seats** from at least 3 states; OR recognised as a state party in **4+ states**

- **State party** — any one: 6% votes in state Assembly + **2 Assembly seats**; OR 6% votes in LS from the state + **1 LS seat**; OR **3% of Assembly seats** (or 3 seats); OR 1 LS seat for every 25 LS seats allotted to the state; OR **8% of valid votes** in the state
- **RUPP (Registered Unrecognised)** — parties that have not secured enough votes, or never contested since registration

- **Alliances: 1967 — end of single-party dominance; 1977 — Janata Party (first coalition government, against the Emergency backdrop); since late 1990s — NDA (led by BJP) and UPA (led by INC) — dissolved 2023, reconstituted as the Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance**

✍ **EXAM POINTS — ANTI-DEFECTION LAW**

- Passed in **1985** through the **52nd Constitutional Amendment Act**; purpose — **prevent defection and provide stability** to the elected government.
- If a member of Parliament or a State Assembly **voluntarily gives up party membership** or **votes against the party's whip**, they can be **disqualified** from the House.
- The **Speaker or Chairman of the House** decides such cases.
- India has a **multi-party system** — many parties exist and compete, reflecting the diversity of languages, cultures, religions and regions.
- Defection can be seen as **political opportunism** — or as upholding conscience and responding to changing public expectations.

T10 Challenges to Free & Fair Elections ⚠

☐ revised

💡 **SAMAJH (HINGLISH)**

96.8 crore voters, thousands of polling stations, hundreds of parties — election conduct karna **world's biggest event management** hai! Challenges: **misinformation, fake news, intimidation** (dhamki/vote dabav). ECI ke jawab: **RP Acts** (laws), **MCC** — Model Code of Conduct (election-time ke rules), **EVMs + VVPAT** (vote ka paper proof — machine ke saath slip dikhti hai!), aur voters' awareness campaigns. Ishani wale case me dekho — wheelchair, volunteers, VVPAT slip, 89 saal ki dadi ka ghar se vote... system har kisi ko include karta hai!

✍ **EXAM POINTS — BEFORE WE MOVE ON (BOOK SUMMARY)**

- Casting a vote is a **constitutional right as well as a duty** of every citizen.
- Elections are the **soul of democracy** — they give every citizen an equal voice in the formation of a government.
- Laws like the **RP Acts of 1950 and 1951**, and bodies like the **Delimitation Commission** and the **ECI**, keep the process free, fair and transparent.
- Political parties present diverse programmes and policies, helping voters make **informed choices**.
- ECI measures against challenges: **RPA 1950/1951, Model Code of Conduct (MCC), EVMs, VVPAT (Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail)**, and voters' awareness campaigns.
- With constant vigilance and active citizen participation, elections become more representative and democracy more robust.

⚖ Differences — Pakka Aane Wale

Basis	Direct Elections	Indirect Elections
Meaning	Citizens vote **directly** to choose their representatives	Citizens vote for representatives who then **choose the leaders**
In India, for	Lok Sabha, Vidhan Sabha, local bodies (Panchayats, municipalities) — every **5 years**	President, Vice President, Rajya Sabha
People's contact	Direct link between voter and representative	Link through an intermediate electoral college

Basis	First Past The Post (FPTP)	Proportional Representation (PR)
Vote for	One **candidate** in the constituency	A **party** (list), not a person
Winner	Candidate with the **most votes** — even below 50%	Seats allotted in **proportion** to each party's total votes
Used in India for	Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha	Rajya Sabha, President, Vice President (single transferable vote)

Basis	National Party	State / Regional Party
Reach	Recognition across **4 or more states**	Recognition in **one state**
Key criteria (any one)	6% valid votes in 4+ states + **4 LS seats**; OR 2% of LS seats from 3+ states; OR state-party status in 4+ states	6% state votes + 2 Assembly seats; OR 6% LS votes + 1 LS seat; OR 3% Assembly seats; OR 1 LS seat per 25 allotted; OR 8% valid votes
Examples	BJP, INC, BSP, CPI(M), AAP, NPP	Parties recognised in their own states

📖 Definition Bank — Chapter 7 (likhne ke liye ready)

Election — process of exercising the right to vote and fulfilling our responsibility as citizens.

Indirect elections — representatives elect the leaders (President, VP, Rajya Sabha).

Electoral system — method of converting votes cast into seats in the legislature.

Proportional Representation — seats in proportion to votes (RS, President, VP).

Majority system — needs >50%; otherwise a second round between the top two.

RP Act 1951 — conduct of elections, campaigns, disputes, corrupt practices.

ECI — autonomous permanent constitutional body (25 Jan 1950); Art 324–329; superintendence, direction, control.

Electoral roll — constituency-wise voter list; only listed citizens can vote.

National Voters' Day — 25 January, with the voters' pledge.

cVIGIL — app to report MCC violations; flying squads respond.

MCC — Model Code of Conduct; election-time rules for parties and government.

Anti-Defection Law — 1985, 52nd Amendment; quitting party or defying whip → disqualification; decided by Speaker/Chairman.

Direct elections — citizens directly choose their representatives (LS, VS, local bodies).

Psephology — scientific study of elections (Greek psēphos = pebble).

FPTP — plurality system; candidate with most votes wins (Lok Sabha, Vidhan Sabha).

Single Transferable Vote (STV) — preference voting; quota = valid votes ÷ (seats + 1).

RP Act 1950 — seat allocation, delimitation, electoral rolls, universal voting at 18+.

Delimitation — fixing number of seats and boundaries of constituencies (Art 82; 1952, 1963, 1973, 2002).

CEO / DEO / RO / ERO — state and district election machinery officers.

SIR — Special Intensive Revision; updating, verifying, correcting electoral rolls.

ETPBS — electronically transmitted postal ballot for service voters.

VVPAT — Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail; printed slip verifying the vote.

Defection — leaving the party on whose ticket one was elected.

RUPP — Registered Unrecognised Political Parties.

✅ MCQ Challenge — 10 Questions (Ch 7)

🎯 Solve karne ke baad score bharo → ____ / 10

Q1. Which of the following is elected through indirect elections?

a Lok Sabha
b Vidhan Sabha
c President of India
d Panchayat members

Q2. In the FPTP system, a candidate wins by securing —

a more than 50% of votes
b the most votes, even if below 50%
c votes proportional to seats
d the party's approval

Q3. Elections to the Rajya Sabha and those of the President and Vice President are held using —

a First Past The Post
b majority system
c proportional representation
d direct elections

Q4. Which of these states does NOT have a bicameral legislature (Vidhan Parishad)?

a Bihar
b Maharashtra
c Karnataka
d Kerala

Q5. The preparation and revision of electoral rolls is mainly dealt with by —

a the RP Act, 1950
b the RP Act, 1951
c the Presidential Act, 1952
d the Anti-Defection Law

Q6. How many Delimitation Commissions has India had so far?

a Two (1952, 1973)
b Three (1952, 1963, 1973)
c Four (1952, 1963, 1973, 2002)
d Five

Q7. The ECI was established on 25 January 1950; its powers and duties are defined in —

a Articles 14–18
b Articles 324–329
c Articles 352–360
d Articles 243(d)–243(t)

Q8. The Special Intensive Revision (SIR) conducted by the ECI aims to —

a update, verify and correct electoral rolls
b conduct exit polls
c train polling officers
d register political parties

Q9. Under the Anti-Defection Law, a member can be disqualified for —

a criticising the government
b voluntarily giving up party membership or voting against the whip
c losing an election
d attending a rally

Q10. 'Voting from home' in the 2024 General Elections was extended across India for —

a all voters
b senior citizens above 85 and PwDs with 40%+ benchmark disability
c government employees only
d first-time voters

🔑 Answer Key — Chapter 7

1 → c | 2 → b | 3 → c | 4 → d | 5 → a | 6 → c | 7 → b | 8 → a | 9 → b | 10 → b

- **1:** President (and VP, Rajya Sabha) = indirect; LS/VS/local bodies = direct, every 5 years.
- **2:** FPTP = plurality: most votes wins, even with less than 50% (Party A with 40% won in Haritbhumi).
- **3:** Rajya Sabha, President and VP use proportional representation (STV for the Councils).
- **4:** The 6 bicameral states: Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Telangana, UP — not Kerala.
- **5:** RP Act 1950 = seats, delimitation, rolls, 18+ voting; RP Act 1951 = conduct and disputes.
- **6:** Four commissions: 1952, 1963, 1973, 2002 (mandated by Article 82).
- **7:** Articles 324–329 provide for the ECI and define its powers and duties.
- **8:** SIR = updating, verifying, correcting rolls — no eligible citizen left out, no ineligible included.
- **9:** 1985 (52nd Amendment): quitting the party or defying the whip → disqualification; Speaker/Chairman decides.
- **10:** First time across India (2024): 85+ senior citizens and PwDs with 40%+ benchmark disability.

📝 Big Questions — Exam-Ready Answers (Ch 7)

Q1. Why are elections essential in a democratic system?

ANSWER

- Elections are one of the most important processes for exercising democratic rights — **regular and periodic elections lie at the core of democracy**.
- They allow people to choose those who make decisions on their behalf; representatives are chosen through **direct or indirect elections**.
- Elected representatives are **accountable to the people** — the right to elect and hold them accountable is ensured through periodic elections.
- Our **vote is the principal means** of exercising this right.
- Elections provide **equality** (every vote equal), **representation** (every voice counts), **accountability** (non-performers can be changed) and **legitimacy** (people's mandate).
- A government cannot continue beyond its prescribed term without seeking the people's mandate again.

Q2. Explain the First-Past-The-Post system and proportional representation with examples.

ANSWER

- **FPTP (plurality system):** each voter votes for one candidate in the constituency; the candidate with the **most votes wins, even with less than 50%** — e.g., in a 3-party contest, Party A with 40% forms the government.
- We elect members of the **Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha** using FPTP.
- **Proportional Representation:** voters vote for a **party**, not a person; seats are allotted **in proportion to total votes** received — e.g., parties with 40%, 35%, 15%, 10% votes get seats in the same proportion.
- Elections to the **Rajya Sabha, the President and the Vice President** use proportional representation (STV for the Vidhan Parishad/Rajya Sabha).
- A **majority system** is the third type: a candidate needs **more than 50%**; otherwise the top two contest a second round.

Q3. What laws govern the conduct of elections in India? Explain their roles.

ANSWER

- **The Representation of the People Act, 1950** — deals mainly with the allocation of seats, **delimitation of constituencies**, and the preparation and revision of **electoral rolls**; ensures every citizen above **18 years** has the right to vote without discrimination.

- **The Representation of the People Act, 1951** — covers all other aspects of the **conduct of elections and post-election disputes**: nomination of candidates, campaigns, voting procedures and dispute resolution.
- It also lists **electoral offences and corrupt practices**: bribery; appealing for votes on religion, caste, race, community or language; using government personnel (gazetted officers, judges, armed forces, police, excise).
- **The Presidential and Vice-Presidential Act, 1952** also governs related elections.
- Together these Acts ensure the **integrity, transparency and accountability** of India's electoral process.

Q4. What is delimitation? Why is it necessary?

ANSWER

- Delimitation is the process of determining the **number of seats** and fixing the **territorial boundaries** in each state for elections to the Lok Sabha and the Vidhan Sabha.
- It aims to keep the **ratio of seats to population as equal as possible** across all constituencies.
- Boundaries of constituencies are **not permanently fixed** — they change with shifts in population density.
- Without delimitation, one MP might represent **five lakh** people while another represents **twenty-five lakh** — defeating equal representation.
- **Article 82** mandates a Delimitation Commission; India has had four — in **1952, 1963, 1973 and 2002**.

Q5. Describe the Election Commission of India and its functions.

ANSWER

- The ECI is an **autonomous, permanent constitutional body** established on **25 January 1950**; **Articles 324–329** define its powers and duties.
- The Constitution vests in the ECI the **superintendence, direction and control** of the entire election process.
- It conducts elections to the **Lok Sabha, Rajya Sabha, Vidhan Sabha, Vidhan Parishad, the President and the Vice President**.
- **Functions:** (i) creates and revises electoral rolls (enumerators, SIR, claims & objections); (ii) decides election schedules considering weather, agricultural cycles, exams and festivals; (iii) registers political parties, allots symbols and classifies them (national/state/RUPP), acting as a quasi-judicial body in disputes; (iv) ensures free, fair and inclusive elections (PwDs, 85+ home voting, Braille EVMs, transgender and PVTG inclusion).
- At the state level, the **Chief Electoral Officer** supervises election work; DMs, SDMs and Tahsildars serve as DEOs, ROs and EROs.

Q6. What is the Special Intensive Revision (SIR)? Why is it necessary?

ANSWER

- SIR is an ECI exercise of **updating, verifying and correcting the electoral rolls**.
- It ensures that **no eligible citizen is left out** and **no ineligible person is included** in the roll.
- It adds all voters — especially **young voters who have just turned 18** and may be left out due to lack of awareness.
- It deletes names on the basis of **death of the voter, change of residence, duplicate enrolment, and being permanently untraceable**.
- The ECI also gives time to raise **claims and objections** against the revised roll and settles them before publishing the final roll.

Q7. What role do political parties play in elections and democracy?

ANSWER

- Political parties are essential to a democratic system — they work directly at the **grassroots level**.
- They **enable voters to make informed decisions** during elections.
- They **organise public opinion**, campaign on specific issues, and **offer voters meaningful choices**.
- Voters learn about candidates, their policies, vision and positions on issues primarily through parties (rallies, manifestos, media debates).
- The **winning party forms the government** — formulating and implementing policies and ensuring accountability; other parties form the **opposition**, participating in debates and committees.
- They provide governance, accountability, representation and public engagement — helping democracy function effectively.

Q8. What is defection? Explain the Anti-Defection Law.

ANSWER

- **Defection** — abandoning or switching from the political party under whose banner a candidate was elected; joining another party or acting independently of party decisions (like voting in the legislature).
- Seen as **political opportunism** in the context of party discipline and stability — though it can also uphold conscience or respond to changing public expectations.
- The **Anti-Defection Law was passed in 1985 through the 52nd Constitutional Amendment Act**.
- Purpose: **prevent defection and provide stability** to the elected government.
- If a member of Parliament or a State Assembly **voluntarily gives up party membership** or **votes against the party's whip**, the member can be **disqualified** from the House.
- The **Speaker or Chairman of the House** decides such cases.

Q9. How are political parties recognised as national or state parties? Mention the criteria.

ANSWER

- The ECI registers and recognises political parties based on **specific criteria**.
- **National party (any one condition):** secures not less than **6% of valid votes in four or more states** plus wins **4 Lok Sabha seats**; OR wins at least **2% of Lok Sabha seats** with candidates elected from at least **three states**; OR is recognised as a state party in **at least four states**.
- **State party (any one condition):** 6% of valid votes in the state Assembly election **+ at least 2 Assembly seats**; OR 6% of LS votes from the state **+ 1 LS seat**; OR at least **3% of Assembly seats** (or 3 seats); OR **1 LS seat per 25 seats** allotted to the state; OR **8% of valid votes** polled in the state.
- **RUPP:** registered-unrecognised parties — those with insufficient vote shares or that have never contested since registration.
- National and state parties are allotted **election symbols**; the ECI insists on **inner-party democracy** (periodic organisational elections).

Q10. What are the challenges to free and fair elections? How does the ECI address them?

ANSWER

- Conducting elections for over **96.8 crore voters** across thousands of polling stations, hundreds of parties and diverse socio-economic realities is a challenging task.
- Major challenges: **misinformation, fake news, and intimidation** of voters.
- The ECI addresses them through the **Representation of the People Acts (1950 and 1951)** — laws covering offences and corrupt practices.
- The **Model Code of Conduct (MCC)** regulates party behaviour during campaigns; **EVMs and VVPAT** (Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail) ensure transparent voting and counting.
- **Voters' awareness campaigns** and inclusive initiatives (Braille EVMs, home voting for 85+ and PwDs, ETPBS for service voters) push the motto **'No Voter to Be Left Behind'**.
- With constant vigilance and active citizen participation, elections become more representative and democracy more robust.

You're exam-ready! 💪🧠

Definitions ratto → system trees revise karo (ECI machinery, FRs, party criteria!) → differences ke tables yaad karo → MCQs solve karke score check karo → big Q&A se answer-writing practice. Civics = sorted. All the best! 🍀